

Google Play — your checklist

You drive the console. I built the package. Work top to bottom; nothing here depends on a later step.

Everything in this file is free unless a price is stated. The only money is the \$25 Play account fee, which you have already paid.

■ 17 AUG 2026 — THE RELEASE BUILD (do this one now; everything below it is done history)

Google granted production access on 15 Aug. Before pressing the final rollout button, one more build is needed: the test version of the app shell had **payments switched off** — people could install, but nobody could pay. The fix is already in the settings file; turning it into the app file (.aab) happens on your computer, because your signing key lives only there.

The two Google deadlines, corrected 17 Aug — Jacques's console is the truth, not the repo's settings file.

The .aab uploaded for closed testing was built with older tools, so Google flagged it and offered an extension:

- **31 Aug (Android 16): TAKE THE EXTENSION Google is offering** — free, one form, moves the date to **1 Nov**. Then this build clears it for real: the update step pulls Google's current tools, which target Android 16.
- **29 Sep (Play Billing 8):** no extension exists, but this build clears it — the update step pulls the current billing library automatically.

1. Find your build folder

The same folder from the first build — it contains `tw-manifest.json` and `android-upload.keystore`. If you can't remember where, search your PC in File Explorer for **android-upload.keystore**.

2. Put the new settings file in it

The repo is public, so you can download it straight from GitHub. Open:

`https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Jacqueslm/app/main/TurnSomeDayIntoOneday/twa/twa-manifest.json`

First rename the old file in your folder to `tw-manifest-old.json` (safety copy). Then save the page as `tw-manifest.json` into the folder (Ctrl+S — make sure the name is exactly that, not `.txt` on the end).

Or by hand: open your `tw-manifest.json` in Notepad and make these say: `"appVersionName": "1.0.1" · "appVersionCode": 2 · "appVersion": "1.0.1" · "features": { "playBilling": { "enabled": true } } · "alphaDependencies": { "enabled": true }` — touch nothing else.

3. Open a command window in that folder

Click the folder's address bar in File Explorer, type `cmd`, press Enter.

4. Build

```
bubblewrap update
bubblewrap build
```

It asks for your keystore password — the one you wrote down when you made the key. (If it says bubblewrap isn't found, run `npm install -g @bubblewrap/cli` first, then try again.) Out comes a fresh `app-release-bundle.aab`.

5. Upload — but do NOT roll out yet

Play Console → **Test and release** → **Production** → **Create new release** → upload the new .aab (it should show version 1.0.1, code 2). Release notes: "First public release." Press **Save** and stop. The rollout button waits until step 8 — Google won't let you create the payment products until it has seen a build that contains billing, which is why the order matters.

6. Create the three prices

Play Console → **Monetize**:

- **Subscriptions** → create ID `pro_monthly` — \$9.99/month — add a **7-day free trial** offer. Activate.
- **Subscriptions** → create ID `pro_yearly` — \$59.99/year. Activate.
- **In-app products** → create ID `pro_lifetime` — \$149.99 one-time. Activate.

The IDs must be exactly those, letter for letter — they're what the app asks Google for.

7. The payment-verification key (do this WITH the AI)

The server never takes a phone's word that a purchase happened — it asks Google directly. For that, Railway needs one variable: `PLAY_SERVICE_ACCOUNT_JSON`. Setting it up is a 15-minute click-path through Google Cloud and Play Console. **When you reach this step, open a session and say "walk me through the payment service account"** — do it together, not from memory. Without this step, a person can pay Google and Pro won't unlock.

8. Roll out

Back to the saved release → **Review release** → **Start rollout to Production**. Managed publishing is off, so it goes live when Google approves. That click is the launch — it's yours.

Before anything else — two deadlines

- **31 August 2026** — new apps must target Android 16 (API 36). The project I generated already targets 36. An extension to 1 November 2026 can be requested if you miss it.
- The **12 testers / 14 days** requirement below is the long pole. It takes a minimum of two weeks of real calendar time. Start it before you polish anything else.

STEP 1 — Install the build tools (one time, on your own machine)

I could not build the .aab for you: this session's network policy blocks `d1.google.com`, so the Android SDK cannot be downloaded here. These commands do it on your machine. **Free**.

1. Install **Java JDK 17 or newer** — <https://adoptium.net> — free.
2. Install **Node.js 18+** if you do not have it — <https://nodejs.org> — free.
3. Open a terminal and run:

```
npm install -g @bubblewrap/cli
```

The first bubblewrap command will offer to download the Android SDK and JDK for you. Say yes. It is a few hundred MB and it is free.

STEP 2 — Generate your upload key (one time)

Read this first: with Play App Signing, Google holds the real app signing key. What you generate here is an **upload key**. If you lose it, Google can reset it — this is recoverable, unlike the old APK world. Back it up anyway.

From inside the TurnSomeDayIntoOneday/twa/ folder:

```
keytool -genkeypair -v \  
-keystore android-upload.keystore \  
-alias upload \  
-keyalg RSA -keysize 2048 -validity 10000
```

It asks for a password twice and for your name and location. Use a real password and **write it down somewhere you will still have in five years** — a password manager, not a sticky note.

Back it up now, before you go further

Copy android-upload.keystore to **two places that are not this computer**:

- a password manager that stores files (1Password, Bitwarden), and
- an encrypted USB stick or a private cloud folder.

Store the password with it, but not in the same file.

It must never reach GitHub

I have already added the guard. Confirm it is working:

```
git check-ignore -v twa/android-upload.keystore
```

That must print a line naming .gitignore. If it prints nothing, **stop** and tell me — the key is about to be committed to a public history.

STEP 3 — Build the .aab

From the twa/ folder:

```
bubblewrap init --manifest=https://www.turnsomedayintodayone.com/manifest.json
```

When it asks, accept the values already in twa-manifest.json — package com.turnsomedayintodayone.app, launcher name Day One, target SDK 36. Then:

```
bubblewrap build
```

You get app-release-bundle.aab. That is the file you upload.

STEP 4 — Create the app in Play Console

1. Play Console → **Create app**.
2. App name: **Turn Someday Into Day One**
3. Default language: **English (United States)**
4. App or game: **App**
5. Free or paid: **Free** (The Android build ships free-tier only. Pro is sold on the web.)
6. Tick the declarations, then **Create app**.

STEP 5 — Upload once to get your fingerprint

This is the step everyone gets stuck on, so read the order carefully.

The assetlinks.json file on your website needs a SHA-256 fingerprint that **does not exist yet**. It is created when Google signs your first upload. So:

1. Play Console → **Testing** → **Closed testing** → **Create new release**.
2. Upload app-release-bundle.aab.
3. Accept **Play App Signing** when prompted.
4. Go to **Setup** → **App signing**.
5. Copy the **SHA-256 certificate fingerprint** under *App signing key certificate* — the long AB:CD:EF: . . . string. **Not** the upload key certificate. Getting these two mixed up is the usual cause of the app opening with a browser address bar showing.
6. Send me that fingerprint, or paste it yourself into .well-known/assetlinks.json replacing REPLACE_WITH_SHA256_FROM_PLAY_CONSOLE_APP_SIGNING.
7. Deploy the site.
8. Check it is live:

```
curl https://www.turnsomedayintodayone.com/.well-known/assetlinks.json
```

You should see your fingerprint and application/json. Until this is right, the app opens with browser chrome around it.

STEP 6 — Store listing

Open the files in store-listing/ and paste them in. **They are drafts — edit them into your voice before submitting.**

Field	File	Limit
App name	01-title-and-short-description.md	30 chars
Short description	01-title-and-short-description.md	80 chars
Full description	02-full-description.md	4000 chars

Do not move or reword the first paragraph of the full description. It is the medical-device disclaimer and it is required.

Privacy policy URL — paste exactly:

```
https://www.turnsomedayintodayone.com/privacy
```

Graphics you must supply

Asset	Size	How many	Required?
App icon	512 × 512 PNG, 32-bit	1	Yes
Feature graphic	1024 × 500 PNG or JPG	1	Yes
Phone screenshots	16:9 or 9:16, each side 320–3840 px	2 minimum , 8 max	Yes
7-inch tablet	same rules	up to 8	No
10-inch tablet	same rules	up to 8	No

You have icons/icon-512.png already. The feature graphic and screenshots you do not have — take the screenshots on a real phone once the app installs.

Screenshot rule that gets apps rejected in this category: no text overlay claiming an outcome. "Day 30" is fine. "Beat your addiction" is not.

STEP 7 — App content declarations

Play Console → **App content**. Work through every card:

1. **Privacy policy** — the URL above.
 2. **Ads** — *No, my app does not contain ads.*
 3. **App access** — *All functionality is available without special access.* (Anyone can create a free account.)
 4. **Content rating** — fill in the questionnaire. Free. Answer honestly; expect a **Teen / PEGI 12** style rating because of mature themes.
 5. **Target audience** — **18 and over**. Do not include under-18 age bands. It pulls in the Families policy and a stack of extra requirements you do not want.
 6. **Data safety** — answers are in store-listing/03-data-safety-answers.md.
 7. **Health apps declaration** — answers are in store-listing/04-health-declaration.md. **Read point 4 in that file before you submit it.**
 8. **Government apps** — No.
 9. **Financial features** — No.
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STEP 8 — The 12 testers / 14 days requirement

Because your developer account is personal and was created after 13 November 2023, you cannot publish to production until you have run a closed test with **at least 12 testers opted in, continuously, for 14 days**.

1. **Testing** → **Closed testing** → **Create a track** (the default *Alpha* track is fine).
 2. **Testers** tab → create an email list → add **at least 12 Gmail addresses**.
 - They must be real people on real Android devices with real Google accounts.
 - Emulators, duplicate accounts and bots do not count.
 - Add 14–15, not exactly 12, so one drop-out does not reset you.
 3. Copy the **opt-in URL** and send it to them.
 4. **Each tester must click the link, accept, and actually install the app**. An invite that is never accepted does not count. This is where it usually fails.
 5. Leave it running **14 consecutive days**. Do not remove testers or pause the track — the counter resets.
 6. After 14 days: **Production** → **Apply for production access**. A three-part form. Google usually answers within 7 days.
- Who to ask:** anyone with an Android phone. They do not have to use the app seriously; they have to install it and stay opted in. Recovery-community contacts, family, friends. Ask 20 to get 12.
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STEP 9 — Verify the wrapper before you ship it

Once the app installs on a real device:

1. Open it. **There must be no browser address bar.** If there is, assetlinks is wrong — recheck STEP 5, and confirm you copied the *app signing* fingerprint rather than the upload key one.
2. You should land on the app, logged out, at the sign-in screen.
3. Create an account and complete onboarding.
4. **Confirm there is no way to pay anywhere in the app** — no prices, no "Upgrade to Pro", no Plans screen, no link out to a payment page. This is the single thing most likely to get the app rejected. Check: Home header chip, Profile, the Nova daily-limit message, and the in-app guide search for "price".
5. Confirm an existing Pro account created on the web still shows Pro features.

Emulator (optional, on your machine)

If you want to test without a phone, install Android Studio (free), then:

```
sdkmanager "system-images;android-36;google_apis_playstore;x86_64"  
avdmanager create avd -n dayone -k "system-images;android-36;google_apis_playstore;x86_64"  
emulator -avd dayone  
adb install -r app-release-bundle.aab
```

Note the emulator must be a **Google Play** image, not plain AOSP, or the TWA will not verify.

STEP 10 — Submit

Once closed testing has run its 14 days and production access is granted: **Production** → **Create new release** → upload the same .aab → roll out.

If it gets rejected

Rejections in this category are almost always one of four things:

1. **A payment surface was found in the app.** Re-check STEP 9 point 4.
2. **The medical disclaimer is missing from the first paragraph.**
3. **The data safety form does not match the privacy policy.** They are read together.
4. **An outcome claim** in the description or a screenshot.

Send me the rejection text and I will tell you which one it is.